

Vietnam

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** November 30, 1955 **Usage:** National and Civil

The gold five-pointed star is for the unity of five groups of workers in building socialism



Red symbolizes revolution and bloodshed

Asia



In 1954 **Vietnam** was divided into north and south. In 1976, the north finally achieved its aim of reunification under communism.

Vietnam's national flag was adopted in 1976 at the end of the Vietnam War when North and South Vietnam were reunited under the new name of the Socialist Republic of Vietnam. This flag had been used by communist North Vietnam since 1955, a year after partition.

It is basically the same as the flag used by the national resistance movement, the Vietminh, led by Ho Chi Minh, in its struggle against the occupying Japanese forces during World War II.

SYMBOLISM OF THE COLORS

The red color of the field stands for the revolution and for the blood shed by the Vietnamese people. The five-

pointed yellow star represents the unity of workers, peasants, intellectuals, youths, and soldiers in the building of socialism.

ARMS OF VIETNAM

The national coat of arms, which was also re-adopted in 1976, had been used by North Vietnam since 1956. It depicts a cog-wheel, symbolic of industry, and the yellow five-pointed star of socialism, enclosed by a garland of rice—the country's main agricultural product. The name of the country is inscribed on a scroll at the base of the emblem. The symbols on both the arms and the flag were inspired by the Chinese flag.